

BRIAN SHIMKUS

APPLIED AI · INTEGRATIONS · CUSTOMER DELIVERY

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Applied AI and integration engineer with 12 years delivering customer-facing software, enterprise integrations, and regulated workflows. Combines hands-on engineering with discovery, workflow mapping, proof-of-value delivery, and stakeholder alignment. Led broker and trader onboarding modernization at Marex, integrated the DocuSign API, ran stakeholder demonstrations, and managed a five-person team. Builds production-minded RAG and API systems with Python/FastAPI, Salesforce, OAuth 2.0/JWT, structured outputs, evals, human review, and reliability controls.

SKILLS

CORE EXPERTISE

APPLIED AI	OpenAI API, LLMs, RAG, LangChain, Pinecone/vector databases, Structured Outputs, evals, guardrails, Python, FastAPI
INTEGRATIONS	Salesforce API, DocuSign API, REST, JSON, OAuth 2.0/JWT, webhooks, SQL, MySQL, AWS
ENGINEERING	TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React, Next.js, Redux, Tailwind CSS, Git, Jest, Playwright, Vercel
CUSTOMER DELIVERY	Discovery, workflow mapping, solution design, demos, POC/POV, stakeholder alignment, technical handoff

WHERE I'VE DELIVERED

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Independent Applied AI & Integration Engineer** Dec 2025 - Present
[Insolla / Consulting and portfolio practice](#)
 - Build customer-facing AI and integration systems across CRM intelligence, identity governance, and document operations, connecting live third-party platforms through REST APIs, webhooks, and automation tooling.
 - Reduced a client's social-media workflow from 8 hours/week to 10 minutes through an automated content pipeline scoped and delivered directly with the owner.
 - Translate discovery into solution walkthroughs, security briefs, proof-of-value plans, and documented technical handoff, keeping customer decisions, data risks, and implementation tradeoffs explicit.
 - Design Salesforce integrations with scoped access, OAuth 2.0 JWT authentication, source grounding, human review, and documented data controls.
- Lead Front-End Developer** Aug 2025 - Dec 2025
[TerraFort / Freelance](#)
 - Led design and development of an early-stage web and mobile platform from concept through delivery.
 - Owned vendor evaluations and scoped third-party and AI integrations with UX, product, and backend teams.
- Senior Front-End Developer** Jul 2024 - Jun 2025
[OCC / Contract](#)
 - Ran weekly stakeholder sessions at a systemically important financial market utility, aligning goals, demonstrating progress, and resolving open questions across workstreams.
 - Delivered React and TypeScript solutions from Figma through test, QA, and production; implemented Mock Service Worker to unblock development from backend dependencies.
- Lead Front-End Developer** Oct 2020 - Jan 2024
[Marex](#)
 - Led the program that digitized broker and trader onboarding at a global financial-services firm, replacing a compliance-heavy paper workflow with an end-to-end digital process.
 - Won adoption from trading and operations teams by partnering with compliance and operations stakeholders to scope each rollout.
 - Integrated the DocuSign API to digitize document signing across products.
 - Led a five-person front-end team delivering stakeholder-driven solutions; designed and ran the team's internship program.

SELECTED WORK

FEATURED APPLIED AI & INTEGRATION SYSTEMS

RelayOps - AI Incident & Integration Workbench

IN PROGRESS

Building a production-grade AI incident and integration workbench for three simulated regulated-financial environments. A deterministic scenario engine supplies known root causes while the system ranks evidence-backed diagnoses, previews approved sandbox actions, and verifies recovery.

Build scope: Python/FastAPI, Next.js, PostgreSQL/vector search, sandbox adapters and MCP tools, webhooks, queues, retries, Docker, CI/CD, observability, and outage drills.

Evaluation + controls: 40 versioned scenarios with holdouts; tenant isolation, tiered tools, human approvals, immutable audit, degraded mode, and zero unapproved actions.

[Case study](#) | [Source code](#)

Salesforce Intelligence

LIVE DEMO

Live RAG assistant for Salesforce Cases, Accounts, and Opportunities. Synchronizes records into Pinecone and returns answers with citations to source CRM rows. Built with Python, LangChain, and OpenAI.

Engineering proof: Turns multi-record CRM research into one sourced response in seconds.

Controls: OAuth 2.0 JWT, scoped fields, server-side credentials, row-level citations, and unsupported-answer handling.

[Case study](#) | [Live demo](#) | [Source code](#)

FOUNDATION

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Senior Front-End Developer / Walker & Dunlop (Contract) - Built Vue.js and Storybook components connected to APIs.	Mar 2020 - Oct 2020
Senior Front-End Developer / ICF - Led the front-end lifecycle and standardized web accessibility across projects.	Jan 2019 - Mar 2020
Front-End Developer / TransUnion - Built a Contentful CMS for marketing owners and deployed it to AWS.	Jan 2018 - Jan 2019
UX Architect and Front-End Developer / R1 RCM - Identified gaps with directors and prototyped AngularJS solutions.	Apr 2016 - Jan 2018
Front-End Developer / TimeZoneOne (Contract) - Built WordPress themes for Athletico and the Chicago Wolves.	Aug 2015 - Apr 2016
Junior Front-End Developer / Kohactive - Built Rails/SASS sites and led client meetings with Aon and Manchester United.	Aug 2013 - Aug 2015

EDUCATION

FORMAL TRAINING

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Graphic Design / Illinois Institute of Art - Chicago - 3.9 GPA, Dean's List	2013
Instructional Design and Technology / Western Illinois University	2008 - 2010